

Filling last-minute openings without the back-and-forth

What we heard from you

- When a client cancels, you or Carla check the Google Sheet (20–30 people) and text several likely matches at once.
- Replies come in at different times. It's hard to keep track of who was contacted and who is still waiting, so the chair often stays empty.
- Last month, two clients both said yes to the same Saturday haircut. One left upset.

“Keep the process moving reliably, without double-booking.”

What matters most, in your words

1/2

Your goal: at least half of last-minute cancellations refilled, without you and Carla constantly watching each one.

HOW THE PROTOTYPE WORKS

One opening, offered to one client at a time, until it's filled

1

You add the opening

Service, stylist and time. That's all Carla needs to enter.



2

It picks the best match

Same service, stylist preference and day, just like today. Whoever joined the waitlist earliest goes first.



3

That one client gets a text

A link to accept or decline from their phone. No account. 15 minutes to answer for same-day openings.

✓ They say yes

The opening locks immediately so no one else can claim it. The client and front desk get a confirmation, and you add it to Square.

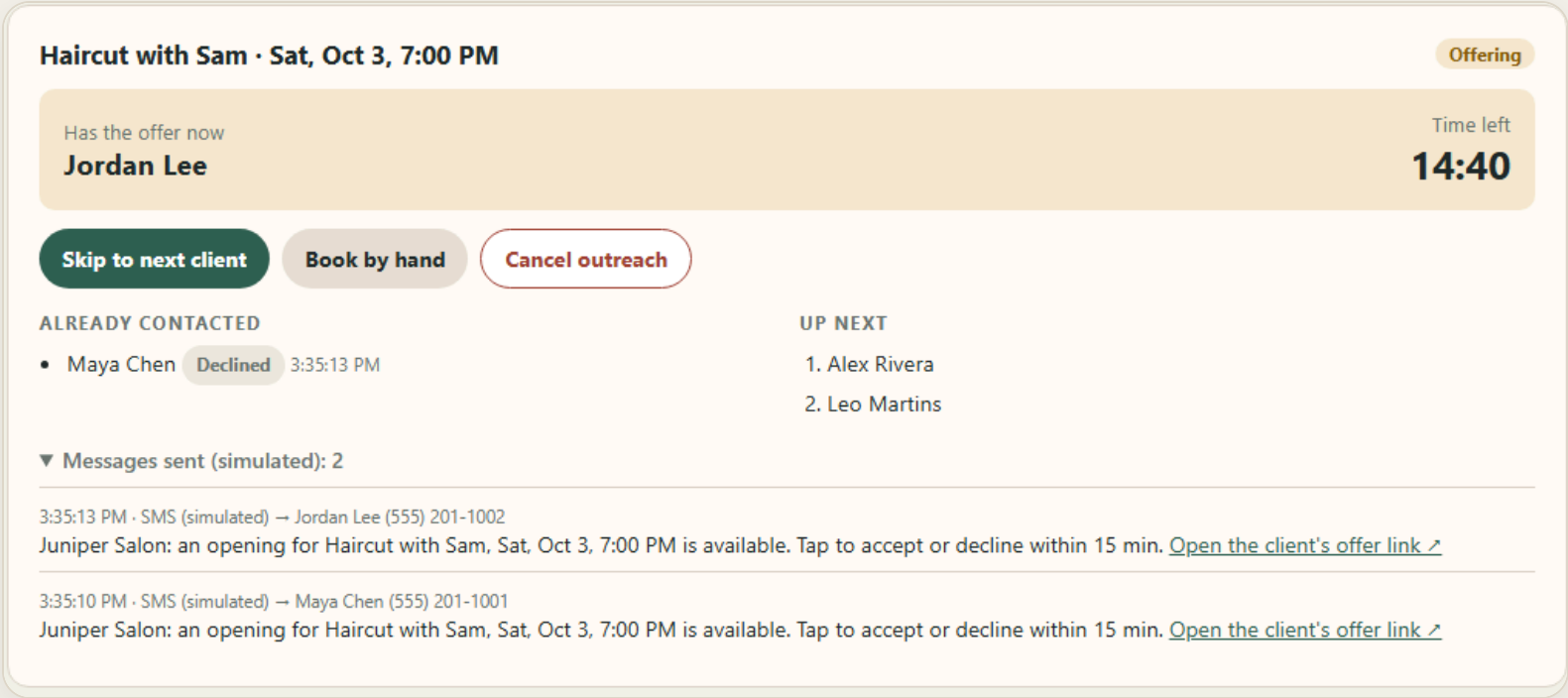
⌚ They say no, don't answer, or you skip them

They get a polite note and stay on the waitlist. The offer moves straight to the next person on the list.

It knows when to stop: it stops offering 1–2 hours before the appointment (you choose) and tells the front desk if the opening wasn't filled.

WHAT YOU, CARLA AND YOUR CLIENTS SEE

Everything you need at a glance, and nothing clients shouldn't see

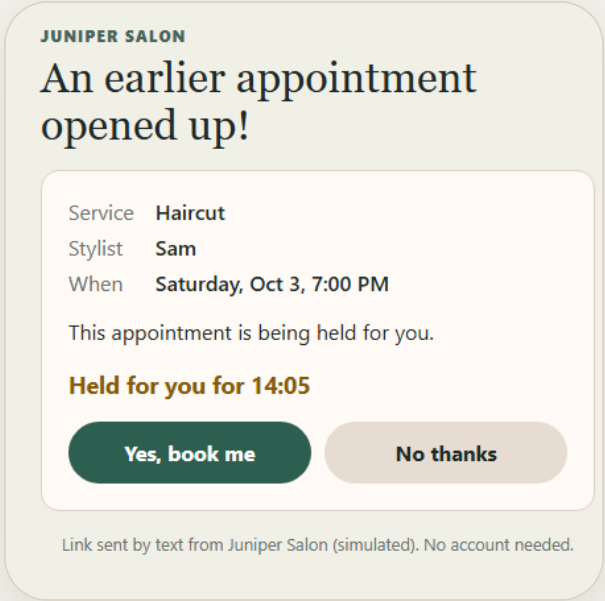


Who has the offer and how much time they have left

Up next: the remaining matching clients, in order

Already contacted: who declined, timed out or was skipped

Step in any time: skip someone, book by hand, or cancel (e.g. stylist unavailable)



The client sees the appointment, a countdown, and two buttons. No other names and no waitlist position.

A late "yes" sees: "This offer has expired or the appointment is no longer available."

WHY YOU CAN TRUST IT

Built so it can't double-book or get stuck

Only one “yes” can win

Only the client currently holding the offer, within their time, can accept. A second or late “yes” is turned away automatically, so last month's Saturday mix-up can't happen.

It keeps moving on its own

The 15-minute countdown runs behind the scenes, not on anyone's screen. It moves to the next client even if no one is watching, and picks up where it left off if a computer restarts.

Everyone hears back

The booked client and front desk get a confirmation. Anyone who timed out or was skipped is told, and stays on the waitlist.

You stay in control

Skip, book by hand or cancel at any point. There's always a clear record of who was contacted and what happened.

Powered by Temporal. Each opening runs as its own process that remembers exactly where it is: who has the offer, when their time runs out, and who's next. It recovers from failures automatically instead of relying on someone to remember.

WHERE THE PROTOTYPE STANDS

What's working, what's simulated, and a practical next step

Working now

- Matching and ordering from the waitlist
- One offer at a time, 15-minute reply window
- Stops 1–2 hours before the appointment
- Accept or decline from a phone, no account
- Staff view with skip, book by hand, cancel
- No double-booking

Simulated

- Text messages and front-desk alerts are shown on screen, not actually sent
- The waitlist is sample data, not your Google Sheet
- Bookings are still added to Square by hand

Not included yet

- Adding clients to the waitlist from the website
- Staff sign-in
- Automatic Square booking

Next step: a two-week pilot for same-day openings

- Connect your real Google Sheet and send real text messages.
- Carla runs every same-day cancellation through it.
- Review together: how many openings were refilled (goal: half or more) and how much chasing it saved.
- Decide how long clients should get for openings a few days out. You weren't sure yet.